

Cheese plays an all-important part in the successful making of Fondue. Only real Swiss cheese, which can be easily recognized by the red mark SWITZERLAND on the rind, provides the requisite qualities. Make sure that you get real Emmental and Swiss Gruyère cheeses, which you will find in all the specialized shops. See that they are really ripe.

To make a Fondue you will need a «Caquelon», which is a kind of saucepan with a handle, made in earthenware or in enamelled cast-iron or steel; an alcohol stove (burner) with an adjustable flame; if possible, those very practical Fondue forks, with their insulated handles and very sharp prongs. If you want to give your table a particularly gay look, you can use coloured porcelain plates. A pepper-mill will complete your equipment for Fondue.

Light and dry Swiss wines are wonderfully suitable for making Fondue. If you cannot find any, make sure that the wine you buy has a sufficiently high acid content. For the same reason do not forget to add some lemon juice to the wine, as mentioned in the recipe.

You should serve either tea or white wine to drink with Fondue. Avoid drinking large quantities of cold liquids when eating, or after eating, Fondue. A small glass of Kirsch—known on this occasion in Switzerland as the «half-time drink»—will add to the relish of your meal. If you cannot find any Kirsch, use some other hard liquor, brandy or gin. Take a loaf of white bread—preferably the long Frenchtype bread with a large amount of crust—and cut it up into small cubes, the sides of which should each measure about $\frac{3}{4}$ to 1 inch. Each cube should have some crust on it.

There is a Golden Rule when eating Fondue: the person who drops a piece of bread into the Fondue has to present a bottle to the company or has to

organize the next Fondue evening.

Ladies have to pay for their clumsiness by giving a kiss to all the other guests.

Recipe

Proportions per person:

6 to 7 oz. of real Swiss cheese, either grated or cut up into thin strips. The ideal mixture is half Emmental and half Gruyère. You will be able to recognise real Swiss cheeses by the red mark SWITZERLAND printed in red on the rind
6 to 8 oz. of white bread cut up into cubes
approx. $\frac{1}{6}$ of a pint of dry white wine

1 teaspoonful of lemon juice

and in addition, per Fondue:

1 clove of garlic

2 teaspoonful of Patent Corn Flour (Argo)

1 glass of Kirsch or some other hard liquor

Spices: pepper, nutmeg, paprika, as desired.

After rubbing the inside of the «Caquelon» with the clove of garlic, pour in the wine to which the lemon juice has been added. Put the Caquelon on a strong flame, and as soon as the wine is hot, add the cheese stirring all the time with a wooden spoon. When this mixture starts to cook, add the Patent Corn Flour previously diluted in the glass of Kirsch, and let it cook for another 2 or 3 minutes. Your Fondue is then ready; you can carry your masterpiece to the table, placing the Caquelon on the burning stove. Season as desired with pepper or paprika.

Everybody has helped himself to bread; in the middle of the table the Fondue continues to cook slowly giving off a strong aroma... the rites are about to begin. One after the other your guests take up a piece of bread on the prong of their fork and dip it into the thick creamy substance. There is no need for hurry with Fondue, but you must stir it so that it remains evenly thick. Slowly the «Grillon» forms at the bottom of the Caquelon. It is the best part of all and must be divided among the guests in a scrupulously fair manner.

An atmosphere has been created, gaiety is in the air... as Fondue always puts everyone in a good mood.